	Nursing action	Rationale
9	Collect about 2cm of formed stool or 20 to 30ml of liquid diarrheal stool	
10	Once the specimen is collected send it to lab with the appropriate requisition forms.	
11	Wash and replace the reusable articles	
12	Dispose off the used spatula wrapped in waste paper.	Prevents contamination
13	Wash and dry hands.	Prevents cross contamination.
14	Record information in the patient's charts.	

Special considerations

1. Send specimen to be examined for parasites immediately, so that parasites may be observed under microscope while viable, fresh and warm.
2. Inform if bleeding hemorrhoids or hematuria is present.
3. Postpone test if woman has menstrual periods, until three days after it has ceased.
4. Consider that intake of folic acid, anticoagulant, barium, bismuth, mineral oil, vitamin C, and antibiotics may alter the results.
5. Use two bedpans for helpless patient- one for collecting specimen and another for cleaning.

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